

Today we turn to our third big question. This question can be introduced by an example.

Suppose that in the year 2069 the surviving members of this Introduction to Philosophy class decided to have an Intro to Philosophy reunion, and all gathered in this room. Suppose that they decided to get a group picture taken.

Now imagine that, via some sort of time travel device, I now have that photo, and show it to you. You might ask: Am I one of those people? Which one am I?

It is very natural to assume that these questions must have determinate answers. There must be some fact of the matter about whether one of the people in the photo is you. And, if one is you, there must be some fact of the matter about which one is you.

Let's suppose that this is true: there must be a fact about whether you survive to be
in this picture, and must be a fact about which of the survivors you are.

Then we can ask a question about these facts:

**The survival
question:** What does it
take for for some
person at some other
time to be you?

To introduce our main answers to the survival question, it will be useful to think about a simple, uncontroversial example of survival.

All of you believe that you will wake up tomorrow in your bed. To put the same point another way, all of you believe that the person now sitting in your seat is the same person as — identical to — the person who will wake up in your bed tomorrow morning.

What do we mean when we say that you are identical to that person?

Here it is important to get clear at the outset on one distinction which, if not attended to, can make these questions more confusing than they have to be.

This is the distinction between **numerical** and **qualitative** identity.

To say that x and y are numerically identical is to say that they are literally the same thing — they are one, not two.

To say that x and y things are qualitatively identical is to say that they are exactly resembling — they have just the same properties.

When we say that you are identical to the person who will get out of your bed tomorrow morning, we are not of course saying that you are qualitatively identical to that person. Their hair will be messed up, and they will be wearing different clothes.

Rather, we mean that you are numerically identical to that person: there is just

one person who is today in this class, and is tomorrow morning in that bed.

But then we can ask the survival question: what makes you numerically the same person as the person who will wake up in that bed?

In a moment we will begin looking at some answers to the survival question. But first let's ask a question: given some different answers to the survival question, how can we tell which one is correct?

This focus on numerical identity is not just an arbitrary choice. Intuitively, this is the question we care about. When we ask about whether life after death is possible, we are not asking whether after your death someone will exist who has the same properties as you. We are asking whether **you** — this very individual — will exist. And to ask this is to ask whether someone numerically identical to you could then exist.

Rather, we mean that you are numerically identical to that person: there is just **one** person who is today in this class, and is tomorrow morning in that bed.

Today we turn to our third big question. This question can be introduced by an

example.

Philosophy class decided to have an Intro to Philosophy reunion, and all gathered in

this room. Suppose that they decided to get a group picture taken.

Suppose that in the year 2069 the surviving members of this Introduction to

show it to you. You might ask: Am I one of those people? Which one am I?

Now imagine that, via some sort of time travel device, I have that photo, and

is you. And, if one is you, there must be some fact about which one is

you.

But is every natural assumption that these questions must have determined answers?

There must be some fact of the matter about whether or not the people in the photo

in this picture, and must be a fact about which the survivors agree.

Let's suppose that this is true: there must be a fact about whether you survive to be

the 1990s, the number of people in the UK who are employed in the public sector has increased by 1.5 million, from 2.5 million in 1980 to 4 million in 1999. The public sector has grown from 10% of the economy to 17% of the economy.

There are a number of reasons for this increase. One of the main reasons is the increasing demand for public services. The population of the UK is increasing, and the demand for public services is increasing. This is due to a number of factors, including the increasing age of the population, the increasing demand for health care, and the increasing demand for education.

Another reason for the increase in the public sector is the increasing demand for public services. The population of the UK is increasing, and the demand for public services is increasing. This is due to a number of factors, including the increasing age of the population, the increasing demand for health care, and the increasing demand for education.

A third reason for the increase in the public sector is the increasing demand for public services. The population of the UK is increasing, and the demand for public services is increasing. This is due to a number of factors, including the increasing age of the population, the increasing demand for health care, and the increasing demand for education.

A fourth reason for the increase in the public sector is the increasing demand for public services. The population of the UK is increasing, and the demand for public services is increasing. This is due to a number of factors, including the increasing age of the population, the increasing demand for health care, and the increasing demand for education.

A fifth reason for the increase in the public sector is the increasing demand for public services. The population of the UK is increasing, and the demand for public services is increasing. This is due to a number of factors, including the increasing age of the population, the increasing demand for health care, and the increasing demand for education.

A sixth reason for the increase in the public sector is the increasing demand for public services. The population of the UK is increasing, and the demand for public services is increasing. This is due to a number of factors, including the increasing age of the population, the increasing demand for health care, and the increasing demand for education.

A seventh reason for the increase in the public sector is the increasing demand for public services. The population of the UK is increasing, and the demand for public services is increasing. This is due to a number of factors, including the increasing age of the population, the increasing demand for health care, and the increasing demand for education.

An eighth reason for the increase in the public sector is the increasing demand for public services. The population of the UK is increasing, and the demand for public services is increasing. This is due to a number of factors, including the increasing age of the population, the increasing demand for health care, and the increasing demand for education.

**The survival
question:** What does it
take for for some
person at some other
time to be you?

To introduce our main answers to the survival question, it will be

useful to think about simple, universal example of survival.

the same point another way, all of you believe that the person now

who will wake up in your bed tomorrow.

All of you believe that you will wake up tomorrow in your bed. To put

sitting in your seat is the same person as — identical to — the person

This is the distinction between numerical and qualitative identity.

attended to, can make these questions more confusing than they have to be.

Here it is important to get clear at the outset on one distinction which, if not

same thing — they are one, not two.

To say that x and y are numerically identical is to say that they are literally the

exactly resembling — they have just the same properties.

To say that x and y things are qualitatively identical is to say that they

When we say that you are identical to the person who will get out of your bed

identical to that person. Their hair will be messed up, and they will be wearing

to morning, we are not of course saying that you are qualitatively

different identities.

one person who is today in this class, and is tomorrow in that bed.

Rather, we mean that you are numerically identical to that person: there is just

But then we can ask the survival question: what makes you numerically the same

person as the person who will wake up in that bed?

In a moment we will begin asking at some answers to the survival question. But

first let's ask question: given some different answers to the survival question,

how can we tell which one is correct?

this is the question we are about. When we ask about whether life after

this very individual — will exist. And to ask this is to ask whether some

death is possible, we are not asking whether after you die someone will

This functional identity is not just arbitrary choice. Intuitively,

numerically identical yet could then exist.

exist with the same properties as you. We are asking whether you —

Rather, we mean that you are numerically identical to that person: there is just

one person who is today in this class, and is tomorrow in that bed.